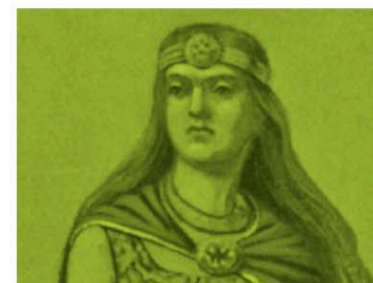




◀ Equal partnership

This fresco of a baker named Terentius Neo and his wife was painted in 55–79 CE in Pompeii. The wife holds a stylus and writing tablet, indicating that she was literate and probably helped to manage her husband's business.



BIOGRAPHY

BOUDICA

Born into a royal family in c. 30 CE, Boudica married King Prasutagus and became queen of the Celtic Iceni tribe that revolted against the Romans occupying Britain in c. 60 CE. After being flogged, having her property seized, and her daughters raped, Boudica led the uprising, but her people lacked the skills and tools to drive the Romans from Britain. Boudica may have poisoned herself to prevent being taken alive by the Romans, or died from an illness in c. 61 CE.

could enter into an informal marriage which had none of the rights of a legal marriage. If a woman had children, they became the property of her owner—also as slaves.

Early Christian women

Christianity became a legally recognized religion after the death of Constantine the Great in 337 CE, who had converted to the faith. Theoretically, the move to Christianity

improved the status of women of Rome, who were encouraged to participate more actively in religion. For example, Constantine's mother, the Empress Helena, played an important role in spreading Christianity, even traveling to Jerusalem to search for biblical relics. In reality, however, Christianity proved even more patriarchal than the pagan faiths, lacking a female deity and closely prescribing women's roles in Church and society.